Writing an Essay

Student sheet · Première and Terminale · tronc commun: B1+ towards B2 in Première, B2 in Terminale · spécialité LLCER: towards C1 · Prompt: “Does globalization necessarily lead to cultural uniformity?” · 250 to 300 words.

Use this sheet in class or at home. The model, the exercises and the answer keys are on the sequence page.

1. Organise your ideas: categories 1, 2, 3

Brainstorm first, then sort. Category 1 becomes body paragraph 1. Category 2 becomes body paragraph 2. Category 3 feeds the synthesis and the close of the conclusion. Set aside what does not serve the question.

Category	My ideas and one precise example	Element of the essay
1		Body paragraph 1
2		Body paragraph 2
3		Synthesis and close of the conclusion

2. The five parts, in order

Part	What I will write (key words) and one sentence starter
Introduction (hook)	
Presentation of the topic (definition, question)	
Argumentation, paragraph 1 (PEEL)	
Argumentation, paragraph 2 (PEEL)	
Synthesis	
Conclusion	

PEEL reminder

Point · Explanation · Example · Link back to the prompt. One idea per paragraph. Examples must be precise (a work, a platform, a practice, a place).

3. Starters and linkers I will actually use

Starter for the hook: .....

Starter for the question: .....

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Two linkers for the body: ..... · .....

Starter for the synthesis: .....

Starter for the conclusion: .....

English punctuation: no space before : ; ? ! · a comma after However, / Furthermore, / Consequently,

4. Words I need

Word or phrase	Short meaning or my example

5. After the first draft

Word count (target 250 to 300): ..... I have a hook and a clear question: yes / not yet. Two PEEL paragraphs with examples: yes / not yet. A synthesis (not only a summary): yes / not yet. A nuanced answer and a short opening: yes / not yet. One passive or one inversion: yes / not yet. Five linkers, with English punctuation: yes / not yet.

Flashcards: I make my own bristol cards (vocabulary, grammar, linkers, starters). The method is on the sequence page. There is no ready-made deck.

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